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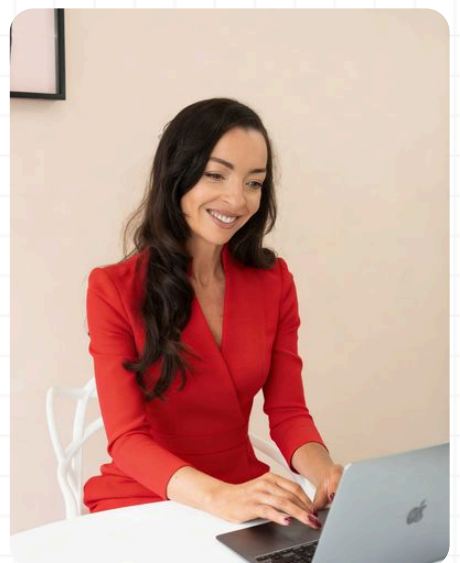
# Start Right With AI

**My Tried & Tested Prompts To Get You Going With AI Now.**

Copy and paste prompts to get started now.

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# 01 Before We Start

If you have tried AI and the output was generic, robotic, or just plain wrong, you are not alone. That is the number one thing I hear from professionals and business owners.

The good news is that it is almost never the tool's fault. **It is almost always the prompt.**

A prompt is simply the instruction you give to an AI tool. The better the instruction, the better the output. No technical knowledge required.

This guide gives you:

1. An understanding of the different ways you can prompt AI.
2. A simple four-part framework you can use every time.
3. 20 ready-to-use prompts you can copy, paste, and start getting results immediately.

I have used every one of these prompts in my own business. They are tried and tested. They work with Claude, ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini, or any other AI tool you choose.

## SARAH'S TIP

You do not need to read this cover to cover. Jump to the prompts you need, copy them, and get going. Come back to the framework and prompting types when you want to write your own.

## 02 What Makes a Good Prompt

Most people prompt AI the way they use Google. They type a few words and hope for the best. **That does not work.**

Google searches for existing information. AI generates new content based on what you tell it. The more context you give, the better the output.

### Weak prompt vs strong prompt

#### WEAK

"Write me an email."

The AI has no idea who you are, who it is for, what tone, or what purpose. It guesses. And guesses are generic.

#### STRONG (USING WHO, WHAT, WHY, HOW)

**WHO** I am a small business owner in Melbourne who runs a digital marketing agency.  
**WHAT** I met a potential client at a networking event last week. They run a mid-sized accounting firm. **WHY** Write a follow-up email. The goal is to book a 15-minute discovery call. **HOW** Professional but warm. Under 150 words.

Same task. Completely different output. The difference is four things:

### Sarah's Framework: Who. What. Why. How.

#### **WHO** Who are you? Who should the AI be?

Set the role. Tell the AI who you are, or assign it an expertise. This shapes everything that follows.

#### **WHAT** What is the context?

Give the background. The situation, the people involved, what has already happened. The more you share, the less the AI guesses.

#### **WHY** What are you trying to achieve?

State the goal. What do you want this output to do? What outcome are you after? This stops generic results.

#### **HOW** How should the output look?

Set the rules. Length, tone, format, structure, what to include, what to leave out. This is quality control.

#### SARAH'S TIP

Think of it like briefing a colleague. You would not say "write me something." You would say "can you write a follow-up email for that accountant I met, keep it short, professional, aim to get a call booked." Same logic. That is Who, What, Why, How in action.

## 03 The Different Types of Prompting

Who, What, Why, How is how you structure every prompt. But there are different approaches you can layer on top. Here are the five worth knowing.

### **BEGINNER** Zero-shot

No examples. Just the task. Fine for simple requests. Generic for anything complex.

```
"Write a subject line for my email newsletter."
```

### **RECOMMENDED** One-shot

Give one example of what good looks like, then ask for more. This single change dramatically improves output.

```
"Here is a subject line I liked: 'The 3 tools I used to save 5 hours this week.' Write me 5 more like this."
```

### **ADVANCED** Few-shot

Give 2-3 examples to establish a pattern. Best for matching tone and style consistently.

```
"Here are three posts that performed well: [examples]. Write a new one matching this style and length."
```

### **ADVANCED** Chain of Thought

Ask the AI to think step by step before answering. Best for complex decisions and analysis.

```
"Walk me through the pros and cons step by step, then give me your recommendation."
```

### **VERSATILE** Role-based

Assign the AI a specific role. Shapes expertise, tone, and perspective.

```
"You are a senior copywriter with 15 years of experience. Review this email."
```

## They all work together

These are not separate choices. The best prompts combine two or three types with your Who/What/Why/How structure. Here is what that looks like:

```
WHO You are a business consultant. I am a real estate agent in Melbourne. WHAT I send a monthly newsletter to 500 past clients. A subject line that worked: "3 things every homeowner needs to know this spring." WHY I need 10 subject lines for my autumn market newsletter. Goal: 30%+ open rate. HOW Under 60 characters each. Mix curiosity, urgency, and value.
```

This combines role-based + one-shot + Who/What/Why/How in a single prompt.

### **SARAH'S TIP**

Start with one-shot prompting. Give one example of what you want, then ask for more. This single change will transform your results overnight.

## 04 Check Your Work

AI is powerful but it is not perfect. Every piece of output needs a human review.

### Step 1: Read it as if someone else wrote it

Does it make sense? Does it sound like you? Would you put your name on it?

### Step 2: Check the facts

AI can and does make things up. Verify statistics, dates, company names, and specific claims.

### Step 3: Check for AI tells

Words that scream "AI wrote this": *leverage, utilise, streamline, cutting-edge, in today's fast-paced world, delve into, foster, harness*. Rewrite in your own words.

### Step 4: Add your voice

AI gives you the structure. Your job is to make it yours. Add a personal anecdote, change a phrase, adjust the tone.

### Step 5: Ask yourself one question

**"Would I send this as is, right now?"**

If no, iterate. "Make it shorter." "Change the tone." "Remove the second paragraph."

### Bonus: Set your language rules upfront

AI defaults to American English. If you use Oxford English (or Australian/British English), tell the AI in your prompt: *"Use Oxford English spelling throughout. Optimise not optimize, colour not color, recognise not recognize."*

Also watch for em dashes. AI loves them. If you prefer cleaner punctuation, add: *"Do not use em dashes."* These small instructions make a big difference to how polished the output feels.

#### SARAH'S TIP

Add your language and formatting preferences to your **HOW** every time. Once you find the rules that work for you, save them and paste them into every prompt. The goal is a 70% head start so you spend your time on the 30% that matters: your expertise, your voice, your judgement.



# 05 Why Most Prompts Fail

## 1. No context

You jump straight to "write me an email" without telling the AI who you are, who it is for, or why.

## 2. Too vague

"Help me with my marketing" is not a prompt. "Write three subject lines for an email campaign promoting a 20% off sale on my online course" is.

## 3. Expecting perfection first try

AI is iterative. The first output is a draft, not a final product. Treat it like a conversation.

## 4. Using AI like Google

Google retrieves information. AI creates content. Different input, different output.

## 5. Not telling it what good looks like

No tone, length, or format specified means generic everything. This is where one-shot prompting transforms results.

## 6. Giving up after one bad result

One bad output means the prompt needs adjusting, not that AI does not work.

### SARAH'S TIP

If your first prompt does not work, try adding "Here is an example of what I want: [paste an example]." This single change (zero-shot to one-shot) fixes most problems.

## 06 20 Tried & Tested Prompts

Copy them, paste them, adjust the [square brackets], and go. Each prompt shows **WHO** **WHAT** **WHY** **HOW** in action.

### Emails

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#### 1. Follow-up email after a meeting

##### BEFORE

Write a follow-up email.

##### AFTER (COPY THIS)

**WHO** I am [your role] at [your company]. **WHAT** I had a meeting with [person's name] from [their company] about [topic]. **WHY** Write a follow-up email thanking them for their time, summarising the three key points we discussed, and suggesting a next step of [specific action]. **HOW** Keep it under 150 words. Professional but warm tone.

#### 2. Cold outreach email

##### COPY THIS

**WHO** I run [your business] in [location]. **WHAT** I want to reach out to [target person/role] at [type of company]. Our service helps them [specific benefit]. **WHY** Write a short introductory email that opens with something relevant to their industry, explains what we do in one sentence, and ends with a soft call to action. **HOW** No more than 120 words. Conversational, not salesy.

#### 3. Reply to a difficult email

##### COPY THIS

**WHO** I received an email from a client who is unhappy with [specific issue]. **WHAT** [paste the email]. **WHY** Write a reply that acknowledges their concern, takes responsibility without being defensive, offers a specific resolution of [your proposed solution], and keeps the relationship intact. **HOW** Professional and empathetic. Under 200 words.



## Proposals and Documents

Best with: Claude

### 4. Proposal outline

#### COPY THIS

**WHO** I am [your role] at [your company]. **WHAT** I need to write a proposal for [client name] who wants [what they need]. Our approach is [brief method]. Budget is approximately [amount], timeline [duration]. **WHY** Create a proposal outline with sections for: executive summary, scope of work, approach, timeline, pricing, and next steps. **HOW** Professional. Short paragraphs.

### 5. Executive summary

#### COPY THIS

**WHAT** Write an executive summary for a [type of project] for [client/audience]. Key outcomes: [list 3]. Investment: [amount] over [timeframe]. **WHY** Written for a senior decision-maker who does not have time for detail. Lead with business impact, not process. **HOW** No more than 200 words.



## Meeting Prep

Best with: Claude | Notes: Read AI

### 6. Meeting agenda

#### COPY THIS

**WHO** I am running a [type of meeting] with [who is attending]. **WHAT** Topic: [topic]. Duration: [duration]. **WHY** Create an agenda with time allocations. Include: [list key topics]. End with action items and next steps. **HOW** Keep it tight. No filler.

### 7. Meeting prep brief

#### COPY THIS

**WHO** I have a meeting with [person/company]. **WHAT** Topic: [topic]. They do [what they do]. **WHY** I want to [your goal]. Create a one-page prep brief with: key talking points, three questions I should ask, potential objections and how to handle them, and a closing statement. **HOW** Keep it practical.



## Content Creation

Best with: Claude | Repurpose: Blotato

### 8. LinkedIn post

#### COPY THIS

**WHO** I am [your role] who helps [your audience] with [what you do]. **WHAT** Write a LinkedIn post about [specific topic]. **WHY** Open with a hook that stops scrolling. End with a question to drive comments. **HOW** Short paragraphs (1-2 sentences). No hashtags. Under 200 words. Tone: [your tone].

### 9. Blog post outline

#### COPY THIS

**WHAT** Create a blog post outline on [topic] for [target audience]. Cover: [3-5 key points]. **WHY** Include a compelling headline, introduction that hooks with a relatable problem, subheadings, and conclusion with a call to action. **HOW** Tone: [your tone]. Length: [word count].

### 10. Social media captions (batch)

#### COPY THIS

**WHO** My audience is [describe them]. **WHAT** I need 5 captions for [platform] promoting [topic]. **WHY** Each needs a hook and call to action. Vary: one educational, one story, one stat, one question, one personal take. **HOW** Each under [word count]. Tone: [your tone].



## Research and Analysis

Best with: Perplexity | Deep dives: NotebookLM

### 11. Competitor analysis

#### COPY THIS

**WHO** I run [your business] in [your industry/location]. **WHAT** Competitors: [list 2-3 if known]. **WHY** Analyse their marketing strengths and weaknesses. What gaps could I take advantage of? **HOW** Comparison table then three actionable recommendations.

### 12. Industry trends

#### COPY THIS

**WHO** I work in [your industry] in [your market]. **WHY** Summarise the top 5 trends likely to affect my business in the next 12 months. **HOW** For each: plain English explanation, why it matters, one practical action. 3-4 sentences max per trend.



## Brainstorming and Ideas

Best with: Claude

### 13. Product or service ideas

#### COPY THIS

**WHO** I run [your business] serving [your audience]. **WHAT** Current offerings: [list them]. **WHY** Brainstorm 10 new ideas that complement my existing business. **HOW** For each: name, one-sentence description, target buyer, estimated price point. Focus on leveraging existing expertise.

### 14. Content ideas for the month

#### COPY THIS

**WHO** I create content for [platform] targeting [your audience]. **WHAT** Content pillars: [list 3-4 topics]. **WHY** Generate 20 content ideas for the next month, grouped by pillar. **HOW** For each: hook (first line) and format (carousel, video, text post, story). Mix 60/20/20 educational/personal/promotional.



## Personal Productivity

Best with: Claude | Automate: Manus, Lindy

### 15. Weekly priorities

#### COPY THIS

**WHO** I am [your role]. **WHAT** Top three goals this quarter: [list them]. Hours available this week: [number]. Tasks: [list 8-10 tasks]. **WHY** Prioritise into: must do this week, can wait, delegate/drop. **HOW** Explain the reasoning for each decision.

### 16. Process documentation

#### COPY THIS

**WHAT** I need to document the process for [specific task] so someone else can follow it. Approximately [number] steps. **WHY** Write as a step-by-step guide with tools needed at each step and common mistakes to avoid. **HOW** Written for someone who has never done this before.



## Client Communication

Best with: Claude

### 17. Project update email

#### COPY THIS

**WHO** I need to update [client name]. **WHAT** Project: [project]. Status: [where things are at]. Milestone: [what was finished]. Next steps: [what is coming]. Risks: [if any]. **WHY** Write a concise update that is professional, transparent, and reassuring. **HOW** Under 200 words.

### 18. Scope of work

#### COPY THIS

**WHAT** Write a scope of work for [project type] for [client]. Deliverables: [list]. Timeline: [duration]. Payment: [terms]. **WHY** Sections for: objectives, deliverables, timeline, included, excluded, and assumptions. **HOW** Plain language, not legal jargon.



## Strategy and Planning

Best with: Claude | Research: Perplexity

### 19. SWOT analysis

#### COPY THIS

**WHO** I run [your business] in [your industry] in [your location]. **WHAT** Target market: [describe them]. Competitive advantage: [what makes you different]. **WHY** Conduct a SWOT analysis with 4 items per category. Then three strategic recommendations. **HOW** Present as a table. Focus on practical actions in the next 90 days.

### 20. Pricing review

#### COPY THIS

**WHO** I offer [your service/product] to [your target market]. **WHAT** Current pricing: [your prices]. Competitors: approximately [range]. Costs: roughly [your costs]. **WHY** Should I increase, decrease, or restructure? Consider value perception, positioning, profitability. **HOW** Three specific pricing options with reasoning for each.

## 07 Sarah's Tool Picks

You do not need 20 tools. You need three to start.

### Your core three (start here)

|                   |                                                                                              |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Claude</b>     | Writing, drafting, reasoning, long-form content, thinking through problems. My primary tool. |
| <b>Perplexity</b> | Research with sources. Facts, data, up-to-date information with citations.                   |
| <b>ChatGPT</b>    | Quick questions, voice chat on the go, troubleshooting with photos.                          |

#### SARAH'S TIP

Start with these three. Get comfortable. The full AI Toolkit at [aieconomy.ai](https://aieconomy.ai) has my complete stack with honest reviews and direct links.

### When you are ready for more

|                            |                        |
|----------------------------|------------------------|
| <b>Presentations</b>       | Claude + Gamma         |
| <b>Social media</b>        | Blotato                |
| <b>Research deep dives</b> | NotebookLM             |
| <b>Meeting notes</b>       | Read AI                |
| <b>Video creation</b>      | HeyGen                 |
| <b>Voice cloning</b>       | ElevenLabs             |
| <b>Website design</b>      | Blink.new, Claude Code |
| <b>Image generation</b>    | Midjourney             |
| <b>Personal automation</b> | Manus, Lindy           |



## 08 What Next

### Start with one.

Pick the prompt that matches something you need to do today. Copy it. Paste it. Fill in the brackets.

### Iterate.

The first output will not be perfect. Tell the AI what to change. It gets better the more you talk to it.

### Save your best prompts.

Build your own prompt library. You will reuse the same 5-10 prompts regularly.

### Try the framework on your own tasks.

**WHO** **WHAT** **WHY** **HOW** Next time you sit in front of a blank prompt box, start with those four parts.

### Experiment with the prompting types.

Start with one-shot. When ready, try chain of thought for bigger decisions and role-based for specialist expertise.

#### Want to go deeper?

**Start Winning with AI (\$97 USD)** The complete guide to understanding AI, mastering Claude, setting up your full tool stack, and building AI into your daily workflow. 5 modules. 25 lessons.

**Ask Sarah (\$149 USD/year)** My AI chatbot trained on everything I know. Not sure what tool to use? Ask Sarah. Join the waitlist at [aieconomy.ai](https://aieconomy.ai).

**The full AI Toolkit (\$49 USD)** My complete stack. 9 categories. Honest reviews. Direct links.

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### AI Economy

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